

USCivics Quiz — Google Ads API Tool Documentation

Internal documentation for Google Ads API Basic access review · August 2026

Internal only

Search campaigns

Single Ads account

This document describes an API tool operated solely for our own Google Ads account. It is not a multi-client SaaS and is not sold to third parties.

1. Product & company

USCivics Quiz (<https://uscivics-quiz.com>) is an independent free study website for the USCIS naturalization civics and English tests (2008 and 2025 versions). Core practice remains free; monetization is primarily consent-based advertising, with optional low-cost study upgrades possible later. We are not affiliated with USCIS and are not a law firm.

2. What the API tool does

A private Node.js operations toolkit in our application repository. It authenticates with OAuth 2.0 and our developer token, then manages **Search** campaigns for a single Google Ads customer ID.

Capability	Status
Create Search campaign + daily budget	Implemented (created PAUSED)
Create ad groups, keywords, responsive search ads	Implemented (PAUSED)
Geo targeting (United States) + language (English)	Implemented
Campaign-level negative keywords	Implemented
Final URLs with UTM parameters to our landings	Implemented
List accessible customers / credential checks	Implemented
OAuth helper to obtain refresh token	Implemented
Display, Performance Max, Video, Shopping, App	Not supported
Manage ads for other advertisers / resell API access	Not supported

3. Intended audience

- **API users:** only our internal marketing/ops operators using our Google Cloud project and Ads account. No external developers or clients call the API through us.
- **Ad click audience:** lawful permanent residents preparing for the U.S. citizenship interview, sent to free landings (N-400 filing date guide, 65/20 senior path, all 128 questions, practice simulation).

4. Architecture

Component	Role
secrets/google-ads.env	Local credentials (never committed to git)
scripts/gads-oauth.mjs	One-time OAuth refresh token via localhost redirect
scripts/gads-check.mjs	Validate required environment variables
scripts/gads-list-accounts.mjs	listAccessibleCustomers
scripts/gads-create-campaign.mjs	mutateResources — budget, Search campaign, criteria, ad groups, keywords, RSA (all PAUSED)
ads/google-ads-editor-import.csv	Human-review / Editor fallback (Paused)
google-ads-api (npm)	Client library for Google Ads API

Flow: OAuth → Customer(customer_id) → atomic mutateResources creating a PAUSED Search structure for operator review before any enablement in the Google Ads UI.

5. Default campaign design

Draft campaign name: **USCQ Search Core** (always created **PAUSED**).

Setting	Value
Advertising channel	SEARCH
Budget	\$10 / day (configurable)
Bidding	Manual CPC
Networks	Google Search only (Display partners off)

Setting	Value
Location	United States
Language	English
Ad groups	AG Filing Date · AG 65-20 · AG All 128
Example landings	/en/learn/n-400-filing-date · /en/learn/65-20 · /en/questions/all-128 · /en/practice/2025

6. Compliance notes

- Landings and ad copy present an independent study tool; not USCIS.
- Website uses HTTPS; marketing cookies load only after consent.
- Tool does not automate click fraud, unauthorized scraping of other accounts, or bulk account creation.
- Developer token and OAuth credentials are used only for our authorized customer account(s).
- Campaigns/ad groups/ads/keywords are created in PAUSED state until a human enables them after review.

7. Operator commands

Command	Action
<code>npm run gads:check</code>	Verify credentials
<code>npm run gads:oauth</code>	Obtain refresh token
<code>npm run gads:accounts</code>	List accessible customer IDs
<code>npm run gads:create-campaign</code>	Create Search structure PAUSED (requires Basic developer-token access on production accounts)

8. Contact

Operator contact: saimek.business@gmail.com

Website: <https://uscivics-quiz.com>

Google Cloud project: uscivics-quiz (project number 833452538943)

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